



# HEALTHY HABITS: MENSTRUAL HYGIENE

Menstruation is a normal biological process that happens when the body sheds the lining of the uterus. Blood and tissue leave the body through the vagina during this time.

Practicing good menstrual hygiene is important for maintaining health, preventing infections, reducing odors, and staying comfortable during your period.

## Using Menstrual Products Safely

Many different products can help manage menstrual flow, including:

- Sanitary pads
- Tampons
- Menstrual cups
- Menstrual discs
- Period underwear

Helpful tips include:

- Wash your hands before and after changing menstrual products
- Dispose of used products properly
- Never flush menstrual products down the toilet

## Personal Hygiene During Your Period

Healthy practices include:

- Wearing breathable underwear
- Changing products regularly
- Washing the vulva daily with water
- Wiping from front to back
- Using unscented hygiene products

It is important to remember that the vagina is self-cleaning. Internal washing, also known as douching, can disrupt the body's natural balance.

## Additional Healthy Habits

Other habits that support menstrual health include:

- Drinking enough water
- Tracking your menstrual cycle
- Paying attention to changes in your period or symptoms

## When to Seek Medical Advice

It may be helpful to consult a healthcare provider if you experience:

- Strong or unusual vaginal odor
- Severe pain during your period
- Very heavy bleeding
- Periods that last much longer than usual
- Major changes in your cycle

## Key Takeaway

Maintaining proper menstrual hygiene is an important part of overall health. Simple habits like changing products regularly, washing hands, and keeping the genital area clean can help prevent infections and ensure comfort during your period.

*Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.*

*Educational content informed by Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Healthy Habits: Menstrual Hygiene.*